



MONTHLY UPDATE

Training and skills: monthly update, July 2026

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36 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Benin

The [first national artificial-intelligence olympiad was held on 9 July](#). No entry numbers, institutions or results are published.

The Council of Ministers authorised a national tele-teaching platform across four public universities for 2026–27, with virtual amphitheatres for students in the hinterland. Two skills programmes ran alongside it. The state's information-systems security officer certification [opened a cohort of 25 on 3 August, taking about 85 officers trained against a target of 100 qualified by end-2026, on CEH and ISO 27001 with practical work at the national cyber range, and widened intake beyond central government to local authorities, state enterprises and the private sector](#). The Sème City hub network runs a francophone digital-skills programme and an annual digital week [alongside a Sorbonne partnership](#); no enrolment or completion figure is published for it.

Benin held a first National AI Olympiad on 9 July. Nothing moved on the national strategy itself, on the generative-AI compliance regime published in June, or on the government super app the presidential programme lists among its existing foundations and which nothing establishes.

Botswana

A [P654.4m contract was awarded by direct procurement on 25 June for a STEAM e-learning, coding and robotics programme](#), its financial evaluation received, adjudicated and approved the same day and the decision published on 8 July. The Court of Appeal cleared the procurement route about six months earlier; that judgment is not held, and this rests on a paywalled lede.

Burkina Faso

The Prime Minister's office ran a two-day session for its senior managers on 13 and 14 July on management tools for ethical and responsible artificial intelligence, a second round after a first for all staff. A parliamentary technology body [trained about thirty lawmakers on 16 July](#) to prepare their review of future legislation.

An operator digital centre marked five years of operation at a ministerial visit on 4 July. The Council of Ministers of 23 July approved the statutes of a technology academy, with no intake, curriculum or budget on record.

Burundi

Vietnam reports that what it has delivered under the November 2024 memorandum is [policy transfer rather than build: drafting experience, reference materials supplied to Burundian agencies, 50 desktop computer sets, and Master's scholarships in computer science](#).

Cameroon

The AI workforce target was carried into the same cabinet review without moving: [60,000 specialists by 2040 including 40% women](#) was set in July 2025, and a year later [AI modules in curricula appear among ten priorities with a roadmap tabled but no adoption, budget line or trainee count](#).

What was delivered was smaller and dated. A first implementation wave under an operator and higher-education memorandum [opened 115 internships across all ten regions on 22 July](#), in disciplines from telecommunications and cybersecurity to finance and law; no stipend, duration or conversion-to-employment figure is published.

Comoros

Two pupils of the private école Mouigni Baraka, Anmar Mohamed and Hafsoit Idrisse, [became Comoros's first entrants to the International Olympiad in Artificial Intelligence, competing at the third edition in Astana, Kazakhstan, from 2 to 8 August 2026](#), selected from four shortlisted candidates drawn from several schools. The delegation was led by Chamsoudine Soudjay, secretary-general of the Association comorienne des technologies de l'information et de la communication (ACTIC), and entered through the Olympiad's GAITE (Global AI Talent Empowerment) programme for emerging nations, with the participation funded jointly by ANADEN, its supervising ministry and ACTIC Academy rather than by any domestic training programme. No result is on record, and the competition's own close falls after this window.

Congo

The national cybersecurity training plan is inside [that tender](#). The country has neither a strategy nor a training plan, and both are being written under a donor-financed contract whose value is not published.

Cote d'Ivoire

The civil-service digital-skills programme [closed its thirteenth edition on 29 July](#), training 192 officials from about thirty public bodies over 40 days, against a cumulative claim of more than 37,500 civil servants funded from the ministry's own budget line.

Outside the service, a German-funded accelerator closed a three-month cohort on 4 August, [closing with 51 artificial-intelligence projects across finance, health, law, education and cybersecurity](#). The project count is the only measure published: participant numbers, cost and what becomes of the projects after the demonstration day are not stated, and a project shown at one is not a deployed system.

DR Congo

The employment office launched a [portal and mobile application in July](#) on which jobseekers register skills and employers post needs, intended to build a national skills database. It was externally financed, and no user or placement figure is held.

Egypt

The state's university artificial-intelligence programme closed its fourth round on 4 August with 1,090 students and 445 projects, taking the cumulative total since 2022 to 2,710 students ([round account](#)). A tripartite agreement added mentoring and real healthcare datasets to student projects, with no data-governance arrangement stated for the patient-derived data.

Eswatini

At the Macetjeni handover the ICT ministry's principal secretary said [AI, robotics, coding and cybersecurity courses would follow](#) at the innovation hubs.

The hub itself opened on 6 August at Macetjeni in the Lubombo Region, [the second of its kind, backed by the development programme with the communications regulator and the small-enterprise development company and aimed at young people, women and people with disabilities](#). It opens against an [internet-usage rate of 58% and youth unemployment of 56%](#). No intake target, running cost or funding term is published, so what a second hub is expected to change cannot be read from the account.

Gabon

Certification training is [under way for participants at Libreville's American Corner under a digital-skills programme run with United States embassies](#). No cohort size or completion date is published.

Ghana

Training capacity was the month's activity. A youth agency [signed for 2,000 vendor-certified microdegree places on 14 July](#) — Ghana taking 2,000 of the 3,000 allocated to the whole continent — fully government-funded, with 600 paid internships and a five-region pilot, and no programme cost disclosed. [A university became the first tertiary institution to embed the national coders programme permanently in its curriculum on 29 July, receiving a further 2,000 laptops the next day.](#)

Guinea

The [software-engineering school Holberton opened its Conakry campus on 16 July 2026](#).

Kenya

The 117th digital hub was [commissioned in Baringo on 20 July](#) on the ceremony series, against a separate installed-base series of about 350 that the programme's own officials also use.

Lesotho

MICSTI reported [digital-literacy training running across all ten districts](#) at the CSIRT launch on 29 July, with no participant numbers published.

Liberia

UNDP also [announced a partnership with the University of Liberia](#) to establish the country's first master's degree in [artificial intelligence](#), with no commitment amount disclosed.

Libya

The Islamic Development Bank Institute [announced on 2 August that it had run an executive programme for Central Bank of Libya officials](#) covering Sukuk issuance, liquidity and portfolio management, treasury operations and settlements, and emerging AI-related security risks. The Libya Observer places the programme at IsDB headquarters in Jeddah from 27 to 30 July 2026. Participant numbers, curriculum and any standard behind the AI component are unstated.

Madagascar

The digital ministry [received 259 applications by 1 August 2026 for ten established civil-service posts](#), split between the capital and the regional directorates. The fields are artificial intelligence, data management, digital innovation, cybersecurity, telecommunications and digital law, the last covering personal data protection and electronic commerce. Applicants have publicly asked for integrity guarantees on the selection, and no appointment has been announced.

Malawi

An operator's school programme reports [36 schools connected with a further nine scheduled in 2026, laboratories equipped with smart televisions and tablets, 12 local e-learning sites zero-rated, and more than 32,000 learners and over 900 teachers benefiting directly](#). All the figures are the company's own; the [continental partnership behind it is worth US\\$57m and targets 5,000 schools across 13 countries by 2027](#). The same foundation's scholarship arm named its [first 25 beneficiaries on 18 August, drawn from 17 districts and taking eight programmes at the science and technology university, computer systems and cyber security among them](#) — the places announced at the January launch, filled seven months later. No continuation beyond the one cohort is stated.

Mali

The same 22 July an operator [reported 350 young people placed on the labour market](#) from its digital centre.

On 30 July UNESCO and Japan [handed the education ministry FCFA 88,740,927 of equipment for eight teacher-training institutes](#) — 40 laptops, 16 all-in-one computers, 32 tablets, and projectors, whiteboards, printers and backup devices — with no maintenance, connectivity or software provision stated.

On 1 August recruitment opened for the first cohort of a [digital-skills programme for 15,000 young people](#) run under a convention with the Association Kabakoo.

Mauritania

The Ministry of Vocational Training [launched a digital-employability project on 23 July](#) financed by France's Fonds Équipe France and implemented by Simplon: 2,150 beneficiaries across six cities, about 2,000 of them young people, with a stated focus on women and people with disabilities. It succeeds a programme closed in 2025.

Mauritius

The incumbent operator opened a national cybersecurity and artificial-intelligence awareness programme for secondary students with the education ministry, [starting on 13 August at the Mahatma Gandhi Institute with about 500 Grade 10 to Grade 12 students drawn from all four education zones](#), and free ten-hour AWS training on offer alongside. A [companion account of the same workshop](#) describes its content as online risk and responsible use of new technologies. It is an operator-run programme rather than a curriculum change, and no full-year target, budget or evaluation is stated.

Morocco

The ministry signed a memorandum with a consultancy in Rabat on 17 July 2026 covering artificial-intelligence skills-building across administrations, universities and research centres, support to institute-backed start-ups and public-service use cases, with no value, term, headcount target or delivery milestone disclosed ([memorandum account](#)).

Mozambique

The institute reported on 23 July that under the World Bank-funded acceleration project 14 training actions had benefited 30 of its technicians and 2,032 professionals from public bodies, private firms and the media had received cyber-security training, with 14 national specialists holding an international incident-response certification ([institute account](#)). The period those cumulative figures cover is not stated.

Nigeria

A [diaspora health-workforce registry is described as newly launched](#), with no launch date, custodian agency, enrolment terms or data-protection basis stated in anything held — a register standing up ahead of its governance.

On 3 August a private university announced [robotics, drone and virtual-reality teaching laboratories](#) to be built by a defence-technology firm that holds a joint venture with the state arms corporation. Lab count, cost, funding source, intake, research ownership and dual-use vetting are all unstated.

[Seventy teachers from 40 Lagos public schools were trained in AI literacy.](#)

On 4 August the [fourth Mastercard Foundation EdTech Fellowship cohort](#) was selected: 12 startups, taking the programme to 72 companies supported since 2019, each offered up to US\$100,000 in equity-free funding over 18 months with Co-creation HUB. The intake is allocated against named categories rather than an open call.

The month's largest single commitment went to the universities rather than the schools: on 11 August [Google.org](#) put US\$1.1m into an [Africa AI Upskilling Programme](#) run by the FATE Foundation across ten Nigerian universities, on a train-the-trainer model that equips lecturers to deliver a localised version of the funder's own curriculum. Nigeria is the first of four countries in a [programme stated at 30 institutions and more than 30,000 students](#), neither of which carries its own date or funding line. The same week the Korean agency [backed a first training-of-trainers cohort in business management and artificial intelligence at the Abuja Centre for Entrepreneurship](#), aimed at the small-business sector and reported by the funder on its own channel, with no cohort size or cost stated. Both are trainer-pool programmes: what neither publishes is what the trainers then deliver, or to how many.

Two smaller items closed the month. The communications regulator [leased its Enugu Digital Industrial Park and Learning Centre to the state government for fifteen years, to be run as a talent city and artificial-intelligence institute](#) for skills training, startup incubation, outsourcing and research — a federal facility handed to a state rather than a new build, with no lease consideration, capacity or opening date published. And a private accelerator [opened a 50-million-naira student aid programme, about US\\$37,000, offering tuition support, a monthly stipend and paid remote internships, closing on 31 August](#); no place count or selection criterion accompanies it.

Rwanda

The digital-ambassador programme that [trained 1,567,034 citizens](#) concluded its financing phase in May 2026 and no successor financing is held.

Where training did continue it went to the top of the system rather than the bottom. The United Nations development programme's quarterly account of 1 August records [artificial-intelligence trust-and-safety training delivered to senior officials, financial and telecommunications actors and the judiciary, funded by Canada](#).

Participant numbers, curriculum and cost are not stated, and the funder's own newsletter is the only account of it held.

Seychelles

The AI Teacher Coach and AI Student Tutor pilots that feed into the AI in Education Framework were both reported already running when State House described the Framework on 31 July 2026 — the Teacher Coach across six schools, the Student Tutor across four — with no exact start dates given for either.

Sierra Leone

MoCTI and three other bodies [launched a digital skills programme for civil servants on 10 July 2026, with 1,000 places in year one and stated targets of 3,000 medium-term and 5,000 long-term](#) across six areas including artificial intelligence and cybersecurity, aimed at gaps outside Freetown.

The country held its [first academic exhibition dedicated to Digital Public Goods on 27 July](#), where [11 student-built solutions were evaluated against the DPG Standard](#). The curriculum behind it, built with UNICEF, the United Nations University and Limkokwing University, has [taught more than 1,100 students and appointed 14 campus champions across four universities](#).

Somalia

In the north, the Somaliland administration [launched fixed-asset training for public financial accountability on 4 August](#). No participant total, system or completion date is stated, and the base carries no earlier position for it.

South Africa

The information technology sector education and training authority was [referred for a governance assessment](#).

The pipeline that authority sits in was reviewed on 14 August. A development bank's report with the higher education department, philanthropically funded, finds [the route from school through universities and technical colleges into employment constrained at both ends — young people arriving without the foundational digital skills the workplace needs, and employers unable to fill digital vacancies alongside high unemployment](#). Its finding is that the mismatch is structural and will not correct itself. That is a verdict on the strategy already under review on this ledger rather than a new instrument.

One intervention was announced against that pipeline, at the far end of the country and five months out. A networking vendor's academy and a private group agreed with the Northern Cape education department to take [networking, cyber security and artificial-intelligence courses into 235 schools as extracurricular classes for grades 10 to 12 from February 2027](#), inside a global programme the vendor says has already trained more than 600,000 South Africans. No learner target, cost, funding split, teacher-training provision or certification pathway accompanies it, and the training figure is the vendor's own.

South Sudan

On 30 July the Central Equatoria state ministry of information [announced a Digital Innovation for Skills and Knowledge programme](#): three digital skills centres in Juba and Yei training more than 8,000 people, put by the state information minister at 5,000 residents and 3,000 civil servants. [The implementing partner put the budget at US\\$2,806,100](#). No financier, signed commitment or start date was named.

Tanzania

The Zanzibar postgraduate technology campus graduated its second cohort on 5 July: [129 students, about half from East Africa and 30% women, with a stated aim of 100 startups](#). The figures are institution-reported and unaudited.

Training opened in Dar es Salaam on 27 July for [110 participants from public, private and non-governmental institutions, across AI, cybersecurity, personal data protection and emerging technologies](#). No budget, duration, certification or repeat cadence was stated.

Uganda

The state ICT institute reports [48,448 people trained in the financial year: 36,332 citizens, 1,932 government officers, 1,207 educators and instructors and 8,977 in immersive and emerging-technology skills](#), with 65 certified trainers produced. The figures are self-reported and unaudited, and [fewer than 4% of those trained were government officers](#).

Zambia

On 20 July the state ICT institute reported training 146 public officers across three district administrations of Southern Province; no cumulative national total is published.

Zimbabwe

The ICT minister told a small-business meeting on 17 July that a digital skills programme targets 1.5 million people ([meeting account](#)).

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